authoritative view of the entity store, rather than on ad hoc checks scattered throughout the application.

At ACME, the entity store for the Customer Collaboration Platform is modeled as a relationship graph. Employees, Customers, Teams, and Documents are nodes, and edges represent relationships such as membership and ownership (for example, `Employee→memberOf→Team` or `Document→owner→Employee`). A nightly process syncs HRIS and CRM updates into this graph, so promotions, transfers, and customer roster changes appear as new edges or attributes without requiring policy edits. Policies stay static, but the data that informs them is dynamic; access changes are reflected through graph updates rather than code modifications.

Figure 9.1 shows a small part of ACME's graph illustrating how the viewer or owner rule is driven entirely by data.

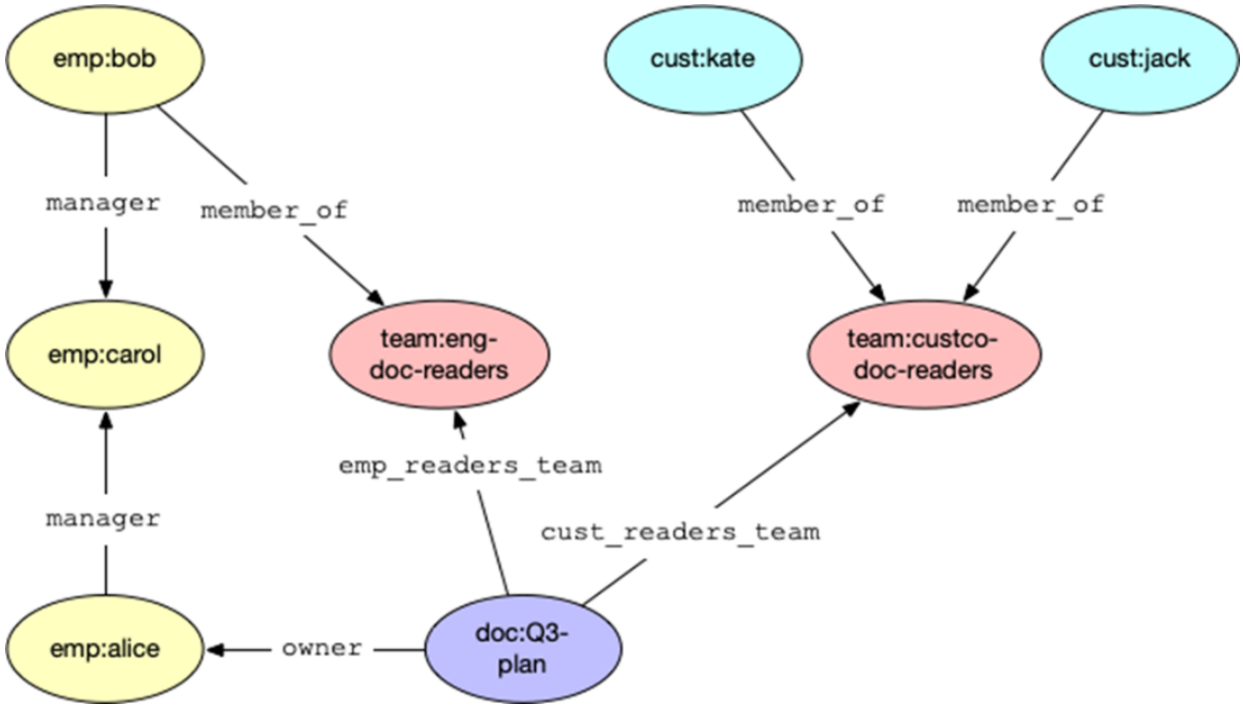


Figure 9.1 A portion of the relationship graph that makes up the entity store for AMCE's Customer Collaboration Platform.

When modeling relationships in the entity store, it's almost always better to represent group membership as relationship edges—such as `principal→memberOf→team`—rather than embed a Set<Principal> inside a team entity. Regardless of the storage technology, the store's job is to answer